Forward Deployed Engineer — Take-Home Challenge

This document covers the process: what you receive, how long you have, the rules you are working under, and how to submit. The problem itself was walked through with you in your interview.

1. What you receive

The download contains the input data and nothing else. There is no starter repository and no scaffolding.

Item	Count	Notes
`emails/*.eml`	48	Raw messages, as they arrived. Some carry attachments
`quotes/*.pdf`	21	Supplier quotes and offers
`master_data.json`	1	Suppliers, cost centres, departments, employees, GL accounts, FX rates
`mock_po_api.py`	1	A stand-in purchase order endpoint. Standard library only

2. Timeline and ground rules

Timeline

When	What happens
Day 0	You receive this document and the example input data.
7 calendar days	Roughly 4 hours of build time. Spread it however you want. We do not track hours.

When	What happens
After submission	A 45-minute interview where you walk us through your solution.

If some questions come up underway, you can still ask via email.

Ground rules

- Any programming language. We do not score the choice.
- Use of Claude Code, Cursor or similar AI coding tools is explicitly encouraged. We do this in our day-to-day.
- Use any libraries, frameworks or hosted services you want.
- You must understand every part of your solution. We will ask things like "why did you pick X over Y?", "what happens if the LLM returns garbage?", "how would you scale this to 500 requisitions a day?". "The AI wrote it" is not an acceptable answer.
- Document the assumptions you made wherever the spec was ambiguous. A short README is fine.
- Commit your work to a Git repository. GitHub, GitLab, or a zip with a `.git` folder are all fine.

3. Approval rules

Approval requirements are driven by the total value of the requisition in CHF.

Total value (CHF)	Required approvers
≤ 1,000	Cost Center Owner
1,001 – 10,000	Cost Center Owner → Department Head
10,001 – 50,000	Cost Center Owner → Department Head → Finance
50,001 – 250,000	Cost Center Owner → Department Head → Finance → CFO
> 250,000	Cost Center Owner → Department Head → Finance → CFO → CEO

4. What to submit

Three things:

1. **A Git repository** with your solution.
2. **A video walkthrough** of your solution. Loom, an unlisted YouTube link, or a file in the repository.
3. **A short README** in the repository covering how to run it and the assumptions you made where the spec was ambiguous.

5. The next interviews:

A remote assessment discussion **1 hour** + meeting with CTO **30 minutes:**

Session 1 — Take-home review (60 min)

Interviewer: Fran Sanchez

What to expect:
You give us a one-minute summary.
Live walkthrough. We will throw a new sample email at your running system and watch what happens.
Technical deep-dive. Expect "why this DB?", "what does your prompt look like?", "what happens if the PDF is 200 pages?", "how would you add a second customer?"
Your questions for us.

Have your solution **running before the call starts**, on the machine you will share. We will give it an email it has not seen before.

Session 2 — Role alignment (30 min)

Interviewer: Sven Beck, CTO

Alignment on the role, your experience, and a Q&A-style conversation.